

Does using ChatGPT instead of Google harm the environment?

Posted by u/AlbinoChic • 0 points • 9 comments

I always hear that AI uses a crazy amount of electricity. Is it really that much more compared to what Google uses? I want to think that either way, they both are negligible for a single person's use.

Comments

u/Avalanc89 • 2 points • 2025-04-22 15:14 UTC

I've read that using Google to do simple search instead of ChatGPT can be even 10 time more every efficient.

u/Tupcek • 1 points • 2025-04-22 12:59 UTC

harming the environment- yes but also no.

It uses more electricity - if this electricity is made from renewable sources, environmental impact per query is negligible.

If you decide to eat meat one less time per month, you most likely save environment much more than your ChatGPT impact.

On the other hand, it saves your time and you also emit emissions, so it depends how do you use that time. If you have worked that time on environment friendly tasks, like planting a tree or separating waste, or even writing your senator to enact carbon tax, it would do more for environment than what ChatGPT uses

u/anomie89 • -1 points • 2025-04-22 08:37 UTC

not nearly as much as reddit.

u/Bearded_Aussie_Nate • 3 points • 2025-04-22 07:44 UTC

It bothers me that people are using cGPT for things that could be a google search, I spoke to someone the other day and they did cGPT instead of googling (or urban dictionary)

u/veryblocky • 1 points • 2025-04-22 13:50 UTC

It's far quicker to find answers using cGPT given how polluted Google has become now

u/alstom_888m • 1 points • 2025-04-22 07:16 UTC

Google just uses its own Gemini AI instead?

u/Tonythepillow • 4 points • 2025-04-22 07:11 UTC

How many single person's uses does it take before it's no longer negligible?

u/LNGBandit77 • 3 points • 2025-04-22 07:07 UTC

You'd be surprised. Although Google put so much effort into routing traffic around the world based on cheap power at certain times of day. Saved them millions I think just by changing the software.

u/toldyaso • 7 points • 2025-04-22 07:06 UTC

Yes, using AI is more harmful to the environment.

While it could be said that a single user can't make a huge difference, it could also be said that if millions of people are using the "I'm only one person" excuse, the harm is magnified by millions.